AI POWERED CUSTOMER INTELLIGENCE TRANSFORMATION PROJECT

SCHEDULE IMPROVEMENT RECOMMENDATIONS REPORT

Client: DOVV Distribution SA

This report translates the findings of the Critical Path Analysis and Schedule Risk Assessment into concrete actions to protect the project's 16-month timeline, organised around the six areas most exposed to schedule risk.

1. Critical Activities

Twenty of the project's 42 activities carry zero float and directly determine the 30 July 2027 completion date. Three of these deserve specific attention beyond routine tracking:

- Task 2.2a-bis (POS API exploration, 12 days): the single longest critical-path task, and the one most exposed to a factor outside the team's control (the POS provider's cooperation). Recommendation: begin provider contact in week one of Phase 2, before this task's planned start, so any access delay is absorbed before it reaches the critical path rather than after.
- The three adoption ramp-up periods (5.wait1/2/3, 160 calendar days combined): the largest single block of critical-path time in the schedule. Recommendation: launch the incentive campaign at full intensity from day one rather than phasing it in, since there is no float to recover a slow start.
- Tasks 7.2a and 7.2b (parallel feedback collection): 7.2a's single day of float is fully absorbed by 7.2b's slightly longer duration, making the pair jointly critical despite appearing minor. Recommendation: launch both on the same day and monitor 7.2b specifically, not 7.2a.

2. Activities with High Schedule Risk

Cross-referencing the Schedule Risk Assessment against the critical path shows that four of the six identified risks (SR-01, SR-02, SR-04, SR-06) sit directly on critical-path activities, meaning their probability and impact ratings are not abstract: any of them materialising delays the project by the same number of days lost. SR-04, the risk of a handover gap between the six roles that rotate critical-path ownership across the timeline, is the least visible of these and the easiest to overlook, since no single task appears at fault when a handover slips.

Recommendation: treat SR-01, SR-02, SR-04, and SR-06 as the four risks requiring active, ongoing monitoring throughout execution, rather than a one-time review at kickoff. SR-03 and SR-05 remain worth tracking but carry Medium rather than High impact.

3. Resource Constraints

The Resource Allocation Plan shows six different roles each carrying critical-path responsibility at different points in the timeline, with no single role continuously accountable for critical-path delivery from month 1 to month 16. This structure is efficient in terms of workload distribution but creates a coordination burden at each phase transition.

Recommendation: introduce a phase-transition checklist, confirming the incoming critical-path owner is briefed and ready before the outgoing owner's final critical task completes, closing the gap identified as SR-04 above.

4. Dependency Bottlenecks

Task 2.4 (internal testing before pilot deployment) and Task 5.1 (card distribution) are the schedule's two convergence points, each requiring multiple predecessor chains to complete before they can start: 2.4 depends on three separate tasks (2.2c, 2.3b, 2.1b), and 5.1 depends on three as well (2.4, 3.2c, 2.0). A delay on any single contributing task delays these convergence points regardless of how well the other contributing tasks perform.

Recommendation: track the three predecessors of 2.4 and the three predecessors of 5.1 as a group at each routine review, rather than individually, since it is their latest finisher, not their average progress, that determines the convergence date.

5. Possible Schedule Delays

The most probable source of delay, based on the Schedule Risk Assessment, is not a single dramatic failure but the gradual erosion of float on Phase 4 and Phase 6 (SR-05): task duration estimates were built without a full technical workshop, and Phase 6 in particular includes an inherently iterative activity (model training and bias correction, Task 6.2a) whose real duration is genuinely uncertain.

Recommendation: use the actual completion time of the first Phase 2 tasks as an early signal of whether duration estimates across the schedule are realistic, before Phase 4 and Phase 6 begin drawing down their float.

6. Actions to Reduce Likelihood or Impact of Delay

- Confirm POS provider documentation access within the first two weeks of the project, ahead of Task 2.2a-bis's planned start (mitigates SR-01, SR-06).
- Launch the adoption incentive campaign at full intensity immediately at Task 5.3, with no phased ramp-up, to preserve the schedule's largest and least recoverable time block (mitigates SR-02).
- Adopt a phase-transition checklist at every critical-path handover between the six rotating owner roles (mitigates SR-04).
- Re-verify Phase 4 and Phase 6 float at the month 4 milestone review, using real Phase 2 completion data rather than original estimates (mitigates SR-05).
- Track convergence tasks 2.4 and 5.1 by their latest-finishing predecessor, not an average of all predecessors, at every routine status update.